

▼ PARADE SHAKO

Date 1806

Origin France

Material Felt, leather

Made of felt or sometimes board with a leather peak, the top of the shako was treated to make it waterproof. When on parade, troops attached cords to them – white for fusiliers, red for grenadiers, and yellow for *voltigeurs*.

White cords for
fusilier companies



Sleeveless cut
allowed freer
movement



◀ FUSILIER'S WAISTCOAT

Date c.1810

Origin France

Material Leather

Waistcoats – also known as undercoats – came in a range of colours and materials. Fusiliers often wore white. On hot days, soldiers sometimes took off their coats and fought in waistcoats.

Corporal's
stripes

White lapels often
treated with pipe clay

Regulation
red cuff with
dark blue flap

Buttons on
pockets



Three buttons
at the cuff

Cream trim

► FUSILIER'S COAT

Date c.1810

Origin France

Material Wool, linen

A fusilier in Napoleon's army wore a coat (*habit à la française*) that was dark blue with red collar and cuffs, together with cream trim and lining. The fusilier would normally also wear a white cross belt and white trousers. Dust, mud, rain, or blood often changed the colour of a uniform when it was worn on campaign.

Rolled-up
greatcoat

Leather straps were
whitened with clay



▲ SOLDIER'S PACK

Date c.1810

Origin France

Material Leather

The soldier's compact knapsack was used for storing extra clothing and rations of bread. Held securely in position by its shoulder straps, the top of the pack also featured stowage points for carrying the soldier's greatcoat.

Buttons for
fastening
over uniform

Leather covering
kept lower legs dry

► FUSILIER'S GAITERS

Date c.1810

Origin France

Material Leather

Gaiters kept dirt and stones out of the soldier's shoes, which often did not fit very well. French military gaiters were often made long, to be worn over the knee, but soldiers cut them down to wear them below the knee.

